

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 869

By Seal

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the members and coaches of the Sevier County High School Smoky Bears football team.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of young athletes is the Sevier County High School Smoky Bears football team, whose members have all proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by finishing runner-up in the 2025 Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association (TSSAA) Division I, Class 5A state championship; and

WHEREAS, a high school football powerhouse, the Sevier County Smoky Bears reached the state championship game after defeating Knoxville West 34-9, Walker Valley 42-7, Lincoln County 28-24, and Knoxville Halls 49-13 to make their fourth championship game appearance; and

WHEREAS, the Smoky Bears enjoyed the stellar leadership and extensive football knowledge of Head Coach Todd Loveday and his staff and the tremendous support of their families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Sevier County High School Smoky Bears football team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a special season but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to pause in their deliberations to acknowledge and applaud the members of the Sevier County High School Smoky Bears football team for their outstanding performance this season; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend the members and coaches of the Sevier County High School Smoky Bears football team upon their runner-up finish in the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class 5A State championship and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.